Though even these can be spoofed by the most ingenious of hackers, you are probably never going to encounter one-unless you happen to work for the government, or are an employee of a huge multinational company. The safest option is to set restricted access only to the specified MAC addresses, as these are much harder to spoof.

Access Point Placement

It's amazing how many people take what is printed on boxes literally. Just because your access point says that it covers a radius of 200 feet doesn't mean that the signal abruptly ceases to exist at that point!

For a home, you most likely aren't going to need an access point in the first place, but in a small office that could be considerably bigger than your home, you might add one in just to keep the signal strength healthy for all your users. However, placing an access point near a window, door or outer boundary wall is not advisable. Since most access points are omni-directional, their signal extends beyond the physical perimeter of your home or office. This means that someone sitting outside your house or office in a car, or a neighbouring building could potentially access your WLAN.

The best way to prevent this is to make sure access points are located towards the centre of your home or office, and you should use a laptop or mobile device to investigate how far out, in all directions your signal extends. A good warning sign that your network extends a little too far out of your perimeter is strangers repeatedly sitting in cars or at neighbouring bus stops, with laptops, chuckling to themselves.

WEP

Wired Equivalent Protocol (WEP) is an encryption standard for 802.11b networks. It was introduced a long ago, and even though it was found to contain severe security flaws, continues to be in use today by somewhat outdated equipment.